| **Extended essay: commentary for example essay** | | | |
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| DP subject:<br>(Subject-focused essay) | **Theatre** | | |
| DP subjects:<br>(Interdisciplinary essay) | | Interdisciplinary framework: | |
| Research question: | How does lighting within the National Theatre's Frankenstein affect an audience's perception of the play? | | |
| Assessment details | | | |
| Criterion: | Mark awarded: | Commentary:<br>(Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria) | |
| **A**: Framework for the essay<br><br>[Maximum possible mark: 6] | **6** | The question encourages the application of relevant theatrical concepts and invites an in-depth examination of a specific design element in a particular performance; its focus is narrowed still further in the introduction.<br>The candidate has made a judicious selection of sources, including solid academic sources, as well as interviews and five professional reviews. A research method appropriate to the RQ is explained and applied. The response to the question is cogent, effectively communicating research findings, conveying knowledge of theatrical lighting techniques. | |
| **B**: Knowledge and understanding<br><br>[Maximum possible mark: 6] | **5** | Discussion is underpinned by knowledge, and more than a dozen illustrative photos are used to further relevant arguments but - while arguments are generally well-documented - there is inconsistent support for some assertions regarding audience perception.<br>Relevant theatre-specific terminology is used fluently and accurately, and is incorporated into arguments, demonstrating understanding of the specific topic. The candidate explains and consistently applies relevant fundamental concepts of stage lighting design to analyses, though some explanations lack clarity. | |
| **C**: Analysis and line of argument<br><br>[Maximum possible mark: 6] | **5** | Analysis is effective and consistently produces relevant findings; the topic is broken down to bring out its essential elements and establish relevant findings. The candidate offers a convincing argument, working methodically through the evidence. On the other hand, the summative conclusion does not directly address the question of *how* lighting affects the audience's perceptions in the specific production evaluated, nor is there a synthesis of research findings. | |
| **D**: Discussion and evaluation<br><br>[Maximum possible mark: 8] | **6** | Compelling arguments are developed through thoughtful analysis of the evidence obtained from research.<br>The candidate critically evaluates lighting design in the performance, and attempts to assess the effectiveness of their research. | |
| **E**: Reflection<br><br>[Maximum possible mark: 4] | **2** | While the candidate offer no examples of how skills have been or can be applied in other contexts they do consider decisions made throughout the process. Some pride in gaining knowledge "from scratch" is expressed, but the entry largely offers descriptions of steps taken, rather than reflections on the process. | |
| Total marks awarded | 24/30 | | |

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| Holistic comment on the essay: | The focus of this essay is clearly dramaturgical, and - with a range of reliable, relevant print sources and scholarly articles on theatrical lighting techniques cited to support core arguments and analyses - its academic context is evident. |